

Absolutely — **cringe** is a very useful Tier 1 target because your passage uses it here:

> “...another claimed the video was **cringe**.”

Here **cringe** is informal internet slang used adjectivally to mean **embarrassing, awkward, or painfully uncool to watch**. But the word also has older/core meanings involving **shrinking back physically, reacting with embarrassment, and figurative second-hand embarrassment**.

Word family: **cringe / cringey / cringeworthy**

Base word: cringe

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun-like slang use / informal adjective-like use

Related adjectives: cringey, cringeworthy

Meaning in your passage: **cringe** = embarrassing / painfully awkward — 尷尬的；令人尷尬得受不了的

Your sentence:

> “another claimed the video was **cringe**.”

Here **cringe** means:

> **so awkward, embarrassing, forced, or uncool that watching it causes second-hand embarrassment.**

繁體中文：

尷尬得令人替對方難受、甚至想避開不看的；很做作 / 很令人起尷尬反應的

Natural translation:

> “the video was ‘cringe’”

「這段影片很**尷尬** / 尷尬得令人受不了。」

So here:

> **cringe** = 網絡口語中指某件事令人強烈感到尷尬、做作或不自然

1. **cringe** = physically shrink back in fear/discomfort — 畏縮；縮起來

The older/core verb meaning.

Practice 1

> “The dog **cringed** when it heard the loud noise.”

「那隻狗聽到巨響時**畏縮**了一下。」

Practice 2

> “He cringed away from the blow.”

「他面對那一下攻擊時**縮身躲開**。」

cringe = 因害怕、痛楚或不適而把身體縮起來 / 往後退

2. **cringe** = react with embarrassment/discomfort — 因尷尬而縮一下；尷尬得難受

A major figurative use.

Practice 3

> “I **cringed** when I heard my old recording.”

「我聽到自己的舊錄音時，尷尬得**縮**了一下 / 難受得不想聽。」

Practice 4

> “She cringed at the awkward joke.”

「她聽到那個尷尬笑話時，尷尬得**渾身不自在**。」

cringe = 因尷尬、難堪或看不下去而產生本能不適反應

This is one of the strongest modern senses.

3. **cringe at** + thing = 對.....感到尷尬 / 難受

A very common construction.

Practice 5

> “I **cringe at** some of my old posts.”

「我現在看到自己以前的一些貼文會覺得**超尷尬**。」

Practice 6

> “He cringed at the memory of what he had said.”

「他一想到自己當時說過的話就覺得**尷尬難受**。」

cringe at X = 因某件事而感到強烈尷尬、不自在或羞恥

4. **cringe = informal adjective-like slang, embarrassing/uncool — 很尷尬的；很做作的**

This is your exact source use.

Practice 7 — Original

> “Someone said the video was **cringe**.”

「有人說那段影片很**尷尬 / 很做作**。」

Practice 8

> “That caption is a bit cringe.”

「那句 caption 有點**尷尬 / 很刻意**。」

cringe — slang = 令人產生強烈尷尬感、覺得不自然 / 做作 / 不酷的

Register:

- * very informal
- * internet/social-media slang
- * common among younger speakers

5. **cringe = second-hand embarrassment — 替別人尷尬；尷尬感**

A noun-like informal use.

Practice 9

> “The whole scene was pure **cringe**.”

「整個場面都是滿滿的**尷尬感**。」

Practice 10

> “I couldn’t handle the cringe.”

「我受不了那種**替人尷尬的感覺**。」

****cringe — noun-like slang = 看到別人的行為時產生的強烈尷尬 / 難受感****

6. ****cringey = 尷尬的；令人尷尬的****

A very common informal adjective.

Practice 11

> “The joke was really ****cringey****.”

「那個笑話真的很****尷尬****。」

Practice 12

> “His attempt to sound cool was cringey.”

「他刻意裝酷的樣子很****尷尬 / 很做作****。」

****cringey = 令人感到尷尬、不自然、做作的****

Spelling variants:

* cringey

* sometimes ****cringy****

****cringey**** is very common.

7. ****cringeworthy = 尷尬得令人難以直視的****

A stronger adjective.

Practice 13

> “The interview had several **cringeworthy** moments.”

「那次訪問有幾個**尷尬得令人不忍直視的時刻**。」

Practice 14

> “The speech was painfully cringeworthy.”

「那場演講尷尬得**令人非常難受**。」

cringeworthy = 尷尬程度高到令人想避開 / 難以觀看的

More standard than slang **cringe** used adjectivally.

8. **cringe** = behave in an excessively submissive way — 卑躬屈膝；畏縮討好

An older but still valid sense.

Practice 15

> “He refused to **cringe** before powerful people.”

「他拒絕在有權勢的人面前**卑躬屈膝**。」

Practice 16

> “They cringed before the ruler.”

「他們在統治者面前**畏縮奉承**。」

cringe = 因害怕或低人一等的感覺而表現得過度順從 / 卑微

Register:

* literary

* formal

* lower priority in everyday modern English

Important distinction: **cringe** vs **embarrassed**

embarrassed

= feeling embarrassed yourself.

cringe

= react strongly because something feels awkward, embarrassing, or painful to witness.

> “I was embarrassed.”

> = 我自己感到尷尬。

> “I cringed watching him dance.”

> = 我看他跳舞時尷尬得不忍直視。

Cringe often has a stronger physical/reactional feel.

Important distinction: **cringe vs awkward**

awkward

= socially uncomfortable, clumsy, or difficult.

cringe

= the strong negative reaction to something awkward/embarrassing.

> awkward moment

> = 尷尬時刻

> cringe moment

> = 尷尬到令人不忍直視的時刻

So:

* awkward describes the situation

* cringe often describes the reaction/evaluation

Important distinction: **cringe vs cringey**

cringe

originally:

= verb

> “I cringe when I watch it.”

cringey

= adjective

> “The video is cringey.”

In modern internet slang:

> “The video is cringe.”

is also very common.

So **cringe** has expanded into adjective-like slang use.

Important distinction: **cringe vs cringeworthy**

cringe

very informal/slang.

cringeworthy

more standard and descriptive.

> “That video is cringe.”

> = 很口語 / 網絡化

> “That video is cringeworthy.”

> = 比較標準，意為令人尷尬得難受

Important distinction: **cringe vs shame**

shame

= feeling of guilt, disgrace, or loss of respect.

cringe

= immediate awkward/embarassed reaction.

> shame

> = 羞恥

> cringe

> = 尷尬到縮起來 / 不忍直視

Cringe does not necessarily involve guilt.

Important distinction: **cringe vs humiliate**

humiliate

= cause someone to feel deeply ashamed/embarrassed.

cringe

= react to embarrassment/discomfort.

> “He humiliated me.”

> = 他令我受辱。

> “I cringed at what he said.”

> = 我聽到他說的話時尷尬得難受。

Important distinction: **cringe vs second-hand embarrassment**

These overlap strongly.

second-hand embarrassment

= feeling embarrassed on someone else’s behalf.

cringe

= the reaction that often results from that feeling.

> “I got second-hand embarrassment watching it.”

≈

> “I cringed watching it.”

Very useful modern contrast.

Important distinction: **cringe at vs cringe from**

cringe at

common:

= react to something embarrassing/unpleasant.

> cringe at an old photo

cringe from

less common:

= recoil from fear/pain/discomfort.

> cringe from a blow

So the preposition often hints at meaning.

Important distinction: **cringe in your passage**

Your sentence:

> “another claimed the video was ‘cringe’.”

Here **cringe** is **not** the verb “畏縮”.

It is informal adjective-like slang meaning:

> **尷尬得令人替作者難受、覺得太刻意或太不自然**

Natural Chinese options:

* 很尷尬

* 很做作

* 尷尬得不忍直視

depending on tone.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **cringe — physical recoil** = 畏縮 / 縮起來
* **cringe — embarrassment reaction** = 尷尬得難受 / 不忍直視
* **cringe at** = 對.....感到強烈尷尬
* **cringe — slang adjective** = 很尷尬 / 很做作的
* **cringe — noun-like slang** = 尷尬感 / 替人尷尬
* **cringey** = 尷尬 / 令人尷尬的
* **cringeworthy** = 尷尬得令人難以直視的
* **cringe — submissive** = 卑躬屈膝 / 畏縮討好

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cringe — physical	因害怕、痛楚或不適而把身體縮起來 / 退縮
cringe — embarrassment	因某件事尷尬、難堪或看下去而產生強烈不適反應
cringe at X	對某件事感到尷尬得難受 / 不忍直視
cringe — slang adjective	令人強烈感到尷尬、做作、不自然或不酷的
cringe — noun-like slang	看到別人的行為時產生的替人尷尬感
cringey	尷尬、做作、令人不自在的
cringeworthy	尷尬程度高到令人想避開 / 難以觀看的
cringe — submissive	因害怕或自卑而過度順從、卑躬屈膝

For your original sentence

> “One accused me of ‘trying too hard to be relatable’, while another claimed the video was ‘**cringe**’.”

The exact meaning is:

**cringe = 那名網民覺得影片太刻意、太尷尬、太不自然，看到時會產生強烈的「替人尷尬」感。
**

Natural translation:

> **「有人指責我『太刻意想讓人覺得有共鳴』，另一個人則說這段影片『尷尬得讓人受不了』。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **cringe from fear** → 因害怕而畏縮

- > ****cringe at an old video**** → 看到舊片時尷尬得難受
- > ****the video is cringe**** → 這影片很尷尬 / 很做作
- > ****pure cringe**** → 滿滿尷尬感
- > ****cringey joke**** → 很尷尬的笑話
- > ****cringeworthy moment**** → 尷尬得令人不忍直視的時刻
- > ****cringe vs embarrassed**** → 對尷尬事作強烈反應 vs 自己感到尷尬